

**Board 1**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 6 2

♥ J 9 5 3

♦ 5 2

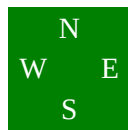
♣ 4 3 2

♠ K 8 7

♥ A 10 6

♦ Q 9 7 4

♣ J 10 8



♠ 10 4 3

♥ K Q 8 7 2

♦ J

♣ 9 7 6 5

♠ A Q 5

♥ 4

♦ A K 10 8 6 3

♣ A K Q

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              |       |      | 2♣    |
| Pass         | 2NT   | Pass | 3♦    |
| Pass         | 4♦    | Pass | 4NT   |
| Pass         | 5♣    | Pass | 5♥    |
| Pass         | 5♠    | Pass | 7NT   |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 7NT by North |       |      |       |

Your 2NT response shows 8+ points, with no 5-card biddable suit.

You support the ♦s and partner bids 4NT. What is your next bid?

With ♦s as trump you have 1 Key-Card, the ♥A. You answer 5♣ and partner bids 5♥. What is your bid?

This is the Queen Ask, wanting to know if you hold the ♦Q. Since you do have it you should bid a suit in which you hold a King. So you bid 5♠. That spurred partner on - he was fishing for 7♦ but when you told him you had the ♦Q, ♥A and ♠K he was able to bid 7NT.

**Board 2**

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 9 7 4 3

♥ 4

♦ 10 9 6 2

♣ 9 4 3

♠ Q 8

♥ A J 9 7

♦ K Q J

♣ A K Q 6



♠ A K J 6 5 2

♥ 5

♦ A 8 7 4

♣ 7 5

♠ -

♥ K Q 10 8 6 3 2

♦ 5 3

♣ J 10 8 2

*West*

Pass

Pass

Pass

All Pass

6♥ by South

*North*

2♣

3♥

4NT

*East*

Pass

Pass

Pass

*South*

2♥

3♠

6♥

Partner's 2♥ is a positive response, 8+ points with a 5+ card suit.

Even though it is tempting, bidding RKCB now would be a mistake because of your doubleton ♠ loser. Instead just support the ♥s. Partner cannot pass, you both know you are forced to game. In fact, partner bids 3♠.

Partner promises first round ♠ control so NOW you can bid RCKB. When you bid 4NT partner answers 6♥. This shows 1 Key-Card and a void in a suit higher than ♥s. Knowing you are missing either the ♦A or ♥K you pass.

**Board 3**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9  
 ♥ J 10 9 2  
 ♦ 10 9 6  
 ♣ 10 9 7 5 2

♠ A Q J 8 5 4 3

♥ 7

♦ A K 4

♣ A K



♠ 6  
 ♥ Q 4 3  
 ♦ Q J 7 5 2  
 ♣ Q J 8 3

♠ K 10 7 2

♥ A K 8 6 5

♦ 8 3

♣ 6 4

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              | 2♣    | Pass | 2♥    |
| Pass         | 2♠    | Pass | 3♠    |
| Pass         | 4NT   | Pass | 5♥    |
| Pass         | 5NT   | Pass | 6♦    |
| Pass         | 7NT   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 7NT by North |       |      |       |

Your 2♥ response shows 8+ points, with at least 5 ♥s.

Your hand is looking better and better. You already gave a positive response so you know you are forced to game. It is better to keep the bidding low to allow more investigating room so you bid 3♠. Partner bids 4NT. What is your response?

With ♠s agreed as trumps you have two Key-Cards, the ♠K and the ♥A. With no trump Queen you respond 5♥. Partner now says 5NT. What do you reply?

Partner is asking for Kings and you have just 1, the ♥K. Remember, the ♠K is not a King, it is a Key-Card which you have already counted. So you bid 6♦. Partner counts 13 tricks and bids 7NT.

**Board 4**

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 10  
 ♥ 10 7 5 3  
 ♦ 9 5 3  
 ♣ A Q 10 7 6

♠ Q J 7 3

♥ A 8

♦ 10 8 6 4

♣ K J 5



♠ 8 2

♥ J 9 4 2

♦ A 7

♣ 9 8 4 3 2

♠ A K 9 6 5 4

♥ K Q 6

♦ K Q J 2

♣ -

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              |       | Pass | 1 ♠   |
| Pass         | 3 ♠   | Pass | 4 ♣   |
| Pass         | 4 ♥   | Pass | 6 ♠   |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 6 ♠ by South |       |      |       |

Partner's 3♠ is a limit raise, 11-12 points and good ♠ support.

What you DO NOT say next is 4NT. If partner answered 1 Key-Card you would not know what to do. If he has a red Ace you can make slam, but if his one Key-Card were the ♣A you couldn't. Instead you make a control-showing bid of 4♣, promising first round control. Partner obliges you by bidding 4♥. What is your next bid?

Partner's bidding is like the Sherlock Holmes tale Silver Blaze, about the dog that didn't bark. Partner's ♥ bid shows that he **DOES** have the ♥A, but equally important it shows that he **DOES NOT** have the ♦A. So you know you don't have a ♥ loser but do have a ♦ loser. You bid 6♠.